

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET C — NCERT EXEMPLAR, IN-TEXT SOURCES & TRICKY QUESTIONS****CHAPTER 06: DEMOCRACY**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-C-06

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET C - NCERT Exemplar & Tricky Questions):

1. The question paper comprises **25 NCERT Exemplar & Critical Application Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Tests **in-text source boxes, fine glossary definitions, historical source extracts, and tricky boundary cases**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **NCERT IN-TEXT & EXEMPLAR TIER:** Questions in this set explore subtle details, specialized definitions, and non-intuitive concepts drawn directly from official NCERT text margins, source boxes, and glossary entries.

Q.1 In 1973, which democratically elected socialist President of Chile was violently overthrown in a military coup led by General Augusto Pinochet with foreign support?

- (A) Salvador Allende (B) Michelle Bachelet
(C) Nelson Mandela (D) Kwame Nkrumah

Q.2 What was the famous independent trade union led by Lech Walesa in Poland in 1980 that sparked the democratic revolution against the Soviet-backed communist regime?

- (A) Solidarity (Solidarnosc) (B) ZANU-PF
(C) Ba'ath Party (D) Kuomintang

Q.3 Kwame Nkrumah, who led Ghana to independence in 1957, was widely praised as a liberation hero, but why was his subsequent rule criticized as a deviation from democracy?

- (A) He made himself President for life in 1964 and banned all opposition political parties, undermining constitutional democratic turnover
(B) He refused to allow anyone in Ghana to read books
(C) He dissolved the military and surrendered the country to Britain
(D) He forced all citizens to speak Latin

Q.4 In which small European nation do citizens continue to practice 'Landsgemeinde' (open-air direct democratic voting by show of hands in public squares) in certain cantons?

- (A) Switzerland (e.g., Appenzell Innerrhoden and Glarus) (B) United Kingdom
(C) France (D) Germany

Q.5 In his famous 1949 address, Dr. B.R. Ambedkar warned that 'Bhakti in religion may be a road to salvation of the soul, but in politics, Bhakti or hero-worship is a sure road to...'

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|--|---------------------------------|
| (A) Degradation and to eventual dictatorship | (B) Eternal economic prosperity |
| (C) The immediate abolition of poverty | (D) Universal world peace |

Q.6 Under the Indian Constitution, which fundamental right is described by Dr. B.R. Ambedkar as the 'Heart and Soul of the Constitution'?

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| (A) Right to Constitutional Remedies (Article 32) | (B) Right to Freedom of Speech (Article 19) |
| (C) Right to Equality (Article 14) | (D) Right to Freedom of Religion (Article 25) |

Q.7 What is the legal difference between 'Rule OF Law' and 'Rule BY Law' in political theory?

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| (A) 'Rule of Law' subjects the state itself to constitutional limits and fundamental human rights; 'Rule by Law' allows authoritarian rulers to use oppressive laws as instruments to control subjects | (B) 'Rule of Law' applies only to lawyers; 'Rule by Law' applies to doctors |
| (C) 'Rule by Law' is practiced only in direct democracies | (D) There is no difference; both phrases mean identical things |

Q.8 Which independent constitutional officer in India is designated as the 'guardian of the public purse' to audit government expenditures and prevent fiscal corruption under Article 148?

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| (A) Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG) | (B) Chief Election Commissioner |
| (C) Attorney General of India | (D) Solicitor General of India |

Q.9 Why was the South African Constitution adopted in 1996 hailed globally as a model of democratic transformation?

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| (A) It was drafted jointly through dialogue between former oppressors and the oppressed, creating a bill of rights that guarantees social, economic, cultural, and environmental rights to all citizens equally | (B) It expelled all white citizens from the country by force |
| (C) It abolished all courts and parliaments in Africa | (D) It established a hereditary monarchy ruled by one tribe |

Q.10 In democratic jurisprudence, what does the Latin writ '*Habeas Corpus*' literally mean, and what vital protection does it provide?

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| (A) 'You shall have the body'—it requires authorities to produce a detained person before a judge to determine whether their arrest is legally justified, protecting against unlawful detention | (B) 'We command the police to seize all property' |
| (C) 'By what warrant does this person hold office' | (D) 'To be certified of the facts in a case' |

Q.11 What is a 'coalition government' in a parliamentary democracy?

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| (A) An alliance of two or more political parties coming together to form a government when no single party secures an absolute majority of seats in the legislature | (B) A government formed exclusively by military generals from different branches |
| (C) A government where all cabinet ministers are under 25 years old | (D) A government that rules without any constitution or laws |

Q.12 How does the 'Preamble' to the Indian Constitution define the fundamental nature of the Indian Republic?

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|--|--|
| (A) A Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic Republic | (B) A Feudal, Monarchical, Colonial State |
| (C) A Capitalist, Authoritarian, Military Union | (D) An Oligarchic, Religious, Regional Territory |

Q.13 What democratic reform did the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act (1978) enact to prevent the arbitrary misuse of Article 352 (National Emergency)?

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| <p>(A) It replaced 'internal disturbance' with 'armed rebellion' and required written cabinet advice to the President before declaring an Emergency, alongside mandatory judicial review</p> | <p>(B) It made the Prime Minister an absolute dictator for ten years</p> |
| <p>(C) It abolished the Supreme Court of India</p> | <p>(D) It prohibited all future general elections</p> |

Q.14 In a democratic nation, what is the role of an 'independent regulatory authority' (such as SEBI, TRAI, or the Competition Commission of India)?

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| <p>(A) To prevent market monopolization, ensure fair consumer competition, and insulate technical market oversight from arbitrary day-to-day political patronage</p> | <p>(B) To arrest business leaders without trial</p> |
| <p>(C) To collect taxes for political campaign funds</p> | <p>(D) To force all private companies into bankruptcy</p> |

Q.15 Why is the practice of 'gerrymandering' considered an undemocratic manipulation of electoral geography?

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| <p>(A) Redrawing constituency boundaries deliberately to pack opposition voters into few districts and spread ruling party voters to gain an unfair seat advantage despite fewer votes</p> | <p>(B) Building high-speed roads through polling booth neighborhoods</p> |
| <p>(C) Printing ballot papers in multiple regional languages</p> | <p>(D) Requiring voters to show photo identity cards</p> |

Q.16 How does the principle of 'Constitutionalism' limit the powers of a democratically elected legislature?

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| <p>(A) Government authority is derived from and bounded by a supreme fundamental constitution; parliament is not supreme and cannot violate constitutional rights</p> | <p>(B) It allows kings to override laws passed by parliament</p> |
| <p>(C) It requires all laws to be written in ancient Sanskrit</p> | <p>(D) It prohibits parliament from meeting more than once every ten years</p> |

Q.17 What is the primary function of the 'Gram Sabha' in India's Panchayati Raj system under Article 243A?

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| <p>(A) A direct democratic village assembly consisting of all registered adult voters in a village, which reviews village accounts, audits welfare beneficiaries, and approves village budgets</p> | <p>(B) A police station where criminals are tried without judges</p> |
| <p>(C) A bank branch that lends money exclusively to rich landlords</p> | <p>(D) A private company that owns all village agricultural land</p> |

Q.18 Why did the Supreme Court of India in the landmark *Maneka Gandhi* case (1978) interpret 'procedure established by law' under Article 21 as requiring 'due process of law'?

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| <p>(A) A law depriving personal liberty must not only be procedurally enacted by parliament, but must also be just, fair, and reasonable rather than arbitrary or oppressive</p> | <p>(B) Laws passed by parliament can never be questioned by any court</p> |
| <p>(C) The police are granted absolute power to detain citizens without trials</p> | <p>(D) Citizens lose their right to life whenever an emergency is discussed</p> |

Q.19 In democratic theory, what is 'deliberative polling' developed by James Fishkin?

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| (A) A method where a representative random sample of citizens gathers to deliberate on policy issues with balanced briefings and expert Q&As before their informed opinions are polled | (B) An instant online survey conducted on social media platforms |
| (C) A secret poll conducted by the military before an election | (D) Polling conducted only among university professors |

Q.20 What democratic protection does the 'Anti-Defection Law' (Tenth Schedule of the Indian Constitution, 1985) seek to achieve?

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| (A) Disqualifying legislators who switch political parties after being elected on a party ticket, curbing opportunistic horse-trading and protecting mandate stability | (B) Prohibiting political parties from holding press conferences |
| (C) Banning candidates from speaking more than two languages | (D) Preventing citizens from voting in two consecutive elections |

Q.21 Why is freedom of the press often called the 'Fourth Pillar' of a constitutional democracy (alongside the Legislature, Executive, and Judiciary)?

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| (A) It operates as an independent watchdog that investigates state wrongdoing, informs the public on national issues, and amplifies diverse citizen voices | (B) It is officially funded and managed by the Ministry of Information |
| (C) It is a specialized branch of the state police department | (D) It has the constitutional power to pass laws and sentence criminals |

Q.22 What is the primary difference between a 'presidential system' of democracy (like the USA) and a 'parliamentary system' (like India)?

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| (A) In a presidential system, the executive is elected independently of the legislature and serves a fixed term; in a parliamentary system, the executive is drawn directly from and is accountable to the legislature | (B) In a presidential system, there are no elections or voting |
| (C) In a parliamentary system, there is no prime minister or courts | (D) Both systems are identical in every constitutional mechanism |

Q.23 Why is the Right to Education (RTE Act, 2009 / Article 21A) considered a foundational democratic enabler in India?

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|--|--|
| (A) Universal free and compulsory primary education empowers children with literacy and critical thinking, which are prerequisites for meaningful democratic citizenship and economic mobility | (B) It forces all children to become politicians when they grow up |
| (C) It bans children from playing outdoor sports in school | (D) It requires students to pass civil service exams at age 10 |

Q.24 What is the constitutional meaning of 'secularism' in the Indian context compared to Western secularism?

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| (A) Rather than strict mutual exclusion (wall of separation), Indian secularism means *Sarva Dharma Sambhava*—principled distance where the state respects, treats, and supports all religions equally | (B) The state is required to ban all religious worship completely |
| (C) The state establishes one official religion and bans all others | (D) Only religious leaders are permitted to become prime ministers |

Q.25 In conclusion, why does a democracy require an active, vigilant citizenry rather than merely good constitutional documents?

- (A) Constitutions are paper scrolls that depend on continuous citizen vigilance, legal defense, and courageous civic action to prevent authoritarian decay
- (B) Constitutions automatically enforce themselves through computer software
- (C) Good constitutions make human citizens completely unnecessary
- (D) Citizens have no role to play once a constitution is printed

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET C)

01	(A) (B) (C) (D)	02	(A) (B) (C) (D)	03	(A) (B) (C) (D)	04	(A) (B) (C) (D)	05	(A) (B) (C) (D)
06	(A) (B) (C) (D)	07	(A) (B) (C) (D)	08	(A) (B) (C) (D)	09	(A) (B) (C) (D)	10	(A) (B) (C) (D)
11	(A) (B) (C) (D)	12	(A) (B) (C) (D)	13	(A) (B) (C) (D)	14	(A) (B) (C) (D)	15	(A) (B) (C) (D)
16	(A) (B) (C) (D)	17	(A) (B) (C) (D)	18	(A) (B) (C) (D)	19	(A) (B) (C) (D)	20	(A) (B) (C) (D)
21	(A) (B) (C) (D)	22	(A) (B) (C) (D)	23	(A) (B) (C) (D)	24	(A) (B) (C) (D)	25	(A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET C)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.1	(A)	President Salvador Allende was deposed on 11 September 1973 in a brutal military coup by General Pinochet, leading to 17 years of military dictatorship in Chile.
Q.2	(A)	Solidarity (*Solidarnosc*), founded at the Lenin Shipyard in Gdansk under Lech Walesa, was the first independent trade union in a Warsaw Pact nation, paving the way for multi-party democracy in 1989.
Q.3	(A)	Nkrumah amended the Ghanaian constitution to establish a one-party state and declared himself president-for-life, until he was ousted in a military coup in 1966.
Q.4	(A)	In the Swiss cantons of Appenzell Innerrhoden and Glarus, citizens gather annually in town squares to vote directly on local laws and budgets by a show of hands.
Q.5	(A)	Dr. Ambedkar presciently cautioned that uncritical personal devotion or hero-worship (*Bhakti*) toward a political leader inevitably leads to the destruction of democracy and autocratic rule.
Q.6	(A)	Article 32 guarantees direct recourse to the Supreme Court via prerogative writs (*habeas corpus, mandamus, etc.*) to enforce fundamental rights, without which rights remain mere paper promises.
Q.7	(A)	Rule *of* Law implies justice, fairness, and institutional checks; Rule *by* Law is authoritarian legalism where despots pass arbitrary draconian statutes to legitimize oppression.
Q.8	(A)	The CAG audits all receipts and expenditures of the Union and State governments, presenting objective reports directly to parliamentary public accounts committees.
Q.9	(A)	Negotiated by the ANC and National Party, the 1996 South African Constitution pioneered non-racialism, reconciliation, and justiciable socio-economic rights (housing, healthcare, water).
Q.10	(A)	*Habeas Corpus* is the bulwark of personal liberty: it compels law enforcement to bring an arrested person to court, preventing secret kidnapping, custodial torture, or indefinite extrajudicial detention.
Q.11	(A)	When multi-party elections produce a hung parliament, parties negotiate a common minimum program and share ministerial berths to form a coalition government.
Q.12	(A)	The Preamble encapsulates the soul of the Constitution: India is a 'Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic' committed to Justice, Liberty, Equality, and Fraternity.
Q.13	(A)	Enacted after the 1975–77 Emergency, the 44th Amendment curbed executive abuse: the President can proclaim Emergency only upon unanimous *written* cabinet advice for 'armed rebellion' or external aggression.
Q.14	(A)	Statutory regulatory bodies maintain level playing fields, curb anti-competitive cartels, safeguard consumer rights, and manage vital sectors based on objective rules rather than political whims.
Q.15	(A)	Gerrymandering manipulates district boundaries for partisan advantage; India avoids this by vesting delimitation powers in an independent quasi-judicial Delimitation Commission.
Q.16	(A)	Constitutionalism rejects unchecked legislative sovereignty: even laws passed by a 90% parliamentary majority are unconstitutional if they breach fundamental rights or constitutional design.
Q.17	(A)	The *Gram Sabha* is the bedrock of direct grassroots democracy: all adult village electors meet periodically to scrutinize the elected Panchayat's expenditures, projects, and beneficiary rosters.
Q.18	(A)	Justice Bhagwati ruled that Article 21's 'procedure' must satisfy the test of substantive justice: oppressive or arbitrary laws cannot justify taking away life or personal liberty.
Q.19	(A)	Deliberative polling measures what citizens would think if they had the opportunity to study balanced evidence, engage with experts, and debate opposing views respectfully.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.20	(A)	The Tenth Schedule prevents the cynical phenomenon of *Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram* by disqualifying MPs/MLAs who voluntarily defect from the party on whose ticket they were elected.
Q.21	(A)	Though not a formal state branch, a free and independent press provides the investigative scrutiny and public exposure necessary to keep the three branches honest.
Q.22	(A)	Parliamentary systems feature fusion of powers (Cabinet is drawn from and must maintain the confidence of the Lok Sabha); presidential systems feature strict separation of powers.
Q.23	(A)	Article 21A recognizes that meaningful democratic citizenship requires literacy: without basic education, citizens cannot read laws, vote knowledgeably, or assert their legal rights.
Q.24	(A)	Western secularism maintains a strict wall of separation; Indian secularism practices principled distance: equal respect for all faiths (*Sarva Dharma Sambhava*) alongside reform of social evils.
Q.25	(A)	As Thomas Jefferson remarked, 'Eternal vigilance is the price of liberty': democratic institutions survive only when citizens actively defend their rights against encroachment.